

Bhagavad Gita - Chapter 1

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

001. Chapter 1 Summary

VERSE 1.1

धृतराष्ट्र उवाच ।
धर्मक्षेत्रे कुरुक्षेत्रे समवेता युयुत्सवः ।
मामकाः पाण्डवाश्चैव किमकुर्वत सञ्जय ॥१॥

dhṛtarāṣṭra uvāca |
dharma-kṣetre kuru-kṣetre
samavetā yuyutsavaḥ |
māmakāḥ pāṇḍavāś caiva
kim akurvata sañjaya ||

- ◆ **dhṛtarāṣṭraḥ uvāca** – Dhritarashtra said;
 - ◆ **dharma-kṣetre** – on the field of Dharma; **kuru-kṣetre** – on the field of the Kurus;
 - ◆ **samavetāḥ** – gathered together; **yuyutsavaḥ** – desiring to fight;
 - ◆ **māmakāḥ** – my people (sons); **pāṇḍavāḥ** – the sons of Pandu; **ca** – and; **eva** – also;
 - ◆ **kim** – what; **akurvata** – did they do; **sañjaya** – O Sanjaya.
-

Dhritarashtra said: Having assembled on the holy plain in Kurukshetra desirous of fighting the battle, what did my people and the Pandavas do? O Sanjaya!

VERSE 1.2

सञ्जय उवाच ।

दृष्ट्वा तु पाण्डवानीकं व्यूढं दुर्योधनस्तदा ।

आचार्यमुपसङ्गम्य राजा वचनमब्रवीत् ॥ २ ॥

sañjaya uvāca |

dr̥ṣṭvā tu pāṇḍavāṇīkaṃ

vyūḍhaṃ duryodhanas tadā |

ācāryam upasaṅgamyā

rājā vacanam abravīt ||

◆ **sañjayaḥ uvāca** – Sanjaya said;

◆ **dr̥ṣṭvā** – having seen; **tu** – but; **pāṇḍava-anīkam** – the army of the Pandavas;

◆ **vyūḍham** – in military formation; **duryodhanaḥ** – King Duryodhana; **tadā** – then;

◆ **ācāryam** – the teacher (Drona); **upasaṅgamyā** – having approached;

◆ **rājā** – the King; **vacanam** – words; **abravīt** – spoke.

Sanjaya said: On seeing the Pāṇḍava army arrayed for battle, King Duryodhana went to his teacher and spoke these words:

VERSE 1.3

पश्यैतां पाण्डुपुत्राणामाचार्य महतीं चमूम् ।
व्यूढां द्रुपदपुत्रेण तव शिष्येण धीमता ॥ ३ ॥

paśyaitāṃ pāṇḍu-putrāṇām
ācārya mahatīm camūm |
vyūḍhām drupada-putreṇa
tava śiṣyeṇa dhīmatā ||

- ◆ **paśya** – behold; **eitām** – this; **pāṇḍu-putrāṇām** – of the sons of Pandu;
- ◆ **ācārya** – O Teacher; **mahatīm** – mighty; **camūm** – army;
- ◆ **vyūḍhām** – arranged in formation; **drupada-putreṇa** – by the son of Drupada (Dhrishtadyumna);
- ◆ **tava** – your; **śiṣyeṇa** – by the disciple; **dhīmatā** – talented/wise.

**O teacher, behold the great army of the sons of Pāṇdu
arrayed by your talented disciple, the son of Drupada.**

VERSE 1.4

| 1.4-6

अत्र शूरा महेष्वासा भीमार्जुनसमा युधि ।
युयुधानो विराटश्च द्रुपदश्च महारथः ॥ 4 ॥

atra śūrā maheṣvāsā
bhīmānjuna-samā yudhi |
yuyudhāno virāṭaś ca
drupadaś ca mahārathaḥ ||

Here are valiant warriors and mighty archers, who are equal to Bhīma and Arjuna in battle. There are also Yuyudhāna, Virāṭa, and Drupada, a great chariot warrior.

VERSE 1.5

धृष्टकेतुश्चेकितानः काशिराजश्च वीर्यवान् ।
पुरुजित्कुन्तिभोजश्च शैब्यश्च नरपुङ्गवः ॥५॥

dhṛṣṭaketuś cekitānaḥ
kāśirājaś ca vīryavān |
purujit kuntibhojaś ca
śaibyaś ca nara-puṅgavaḥ ||

- ◆ **dhṛṣṭaketuḥ** – Dhrishtaketu; **cekitānaḥ** – Chekitana;
- ◆ **kāśirājaḥ** – the King of Kashi; **ca** – and; **vīryavān** – valiant;
- ◆ **purujit** – Purujit; **kuntibhojaḥ** – Kuntibhoja; **ca** – and;
- ◆ **śaibyaḥ** – Shaibya; **ca** – and; **nara-puṅgavaḥ** – best among men.

**Dhṛṣṭaketu, Cekitāna, and the valiant King of Kāśi; also
Purujit, Kuntibhoja, and Śaibya, the foremost among men.**

VERSE 1.6

युधामन्युश्च विक्रान्त उत्तमौजाश्च वीर्यवान् ।
सौभद्रो द्रौपदेयाश्च सर्व एव महारथाः ॥ ६ ॥

yudhāmanyuś ca vikrānta
uttamaujāś ca vīryavān |
saubhadro draupadeyāś ca
sarva eva mahārathāḥ ||

- ◆ **yudhāmanyuḥ** – Yudhamanyu; **ca** – and; **vikrāntaḥ** – courageous;
- ◆ **uttamaujāḥ** – Uttamauja; **ca** – and; **vīryavān** – valiant;
- ◆ **saubhadraḥ** – the son of Subhadra (Abhimanyu);
- ◆ **draupadeyāḥ** – the sons of Draupadi; **ca** – and; **sarve** – all; **eva** – certainly;
mahā-rathāḥ – great chariot-warriors.

**Powerful Yudhāmanyu, brave Uttamaujā, Subhadrā's son,
and the sons of Draupadi - all mahārathas indeed.**

VERSE 1.7

अस्माकं तु विशिष्टा ये तान्निबोध द्विजोत्तम ।
नायका मम सैन्यस्य संज्ञार्थं तान्ब्रवीमि ते ॥७॥

asmākaṃ tu viśiṣṭā ye
tān nibodha dvijottama |
nāyakā mama sainyasya
saṃjñārthaṃ tān bravāmi te ||

- ◆ **asmākaṃ** – ours; **tu** – but/on the other hand; **viśiṣṭāḥ** – the distinguished; **ye** – who;
- ◆ **tān** – them; **nibodha** – know/be informed; **dvija-uttama** – O best of the twice-born (Drona);
- ◆ **nāyakāḥ** – the leaders; **mama** – my; **sainyasya** – of the army;
- ◆ **saṃjñā-arthaṃ** – for the sake of information; **tān** – them; **bravāmi** – I speak; **te** – to you.

O best of the twice-born, let me also recount to you the leaders of my own army, those distinguished amongst ourselves. I shall name them, that you may know them all:

VERSE 1.8

**Yourself and Bhishma and Karna; Kripa, who is ever
victorious in war; Ásvatthāmā, Vikarna, Jayadratha, and
Somadatta's son;**

VERSE 1.9

अन्ये च बहवः शूरा मदर्थे त्यक्तजीविताः ।
नानाशस्त्रप्रहरणाः सर्वे युद्धविशारदाः ॥ ९ ॥

anye ca bahavaḥ śūrā
mad-arthe tyakta-jīvitāḥ |
nānā-śastra-praharaṇāḥ
sarve yuddha-viśāradaḥ ||

- ◆ **anye** – others; **ca** – and; **bahavaḥ** – many; **śūrāḥ** – heroes;
- ◆ **mat-arthe** – for my sake; **tyakta-jīvitāḥ** – prepared to give up their lives;
- ◆ **nānā** – various; **śastra** – weapons; **praharaṇāḥ** – equipped with;
- ◆ **sarve** – all; **yuddha-viśāradaḥ** – experts in warfare.

**And many other heroes besides, armed with many weapons,
each well skilled in battle, and all resolved to lay down their
lives to serve my cause.**

VERSE 1.10

अपर्याप्तं तदस्माकं बलं भीष्माभिरक्षितम् ।
पर्याप्तं त्विदमेतेषां बलं भीमाभिरक्षितम् ॥१०॥

aparyāptam tad asmākaṃ
balaṃ bhīṣmābhirakṣitam |
paryāptam tv idam eteṣāṃ
balaṃ bhīmābhirakṣitam ||

- ◆ **aparyāptam** – immeasurable/unlimited; **tad** – that; **asmākaṃ** – ours;
- ◆ **balaṃ** – strength/army; **bhīṣma-abhirakṣitam** – marshalled by Bhishma;
- ◆ **paryāptam** – limited/measurable; **tu** – but; **idam** – this; **eteṣāṃ** – of theirs;
- ◆ **balaṃ** – strength/army; **bhīma-abhirakṣitam** – marshalled by Bhima.

(Having named the various warriors on both sides
Duryodhana now declares that his own army is superior.) But
this army of ours, protected by Bhishma, is unlimited, and
that army of theirs, protected by Bhima, is limited.

VERSE 1.11

अयनेषु च सर्वेषु यथाभागमवस्थिताः ।
भीष्ममेवाभिरक्षन्तु भवन्तः सर्व एव हि ॥११॥

ayaneṣu ca sarveṣu
yathā-bhāgam avasthitāḥ |
bhīṣmam evābhirakṣantu
bhavantaḥ sarva eva hi ||

- ◆ ayaneṣu – in the strategic points; ca – and; sarveṣu – in all;
- ◆ yathā-bhāgam – in your respective positions; avasthitāḥ – stationed;
- ◆ bhīṣmam – Bhishma; eva – alone; abhirakṣantu – should protect;
- ◆ bhavantaḥ – you; sarve – all; eva hi – certainly.

Now take your proper places in front of your marshalled troops and protect Bhishma alone.

VERSE 1.12

तस्य सञ्जनयन् हर्षं कुरुवृद्धः पितामहः ।
सिंहनादं विनद्योच्चैः शङ्खं दध्मौ प्रतापवान् ॥१२॥

tasya sañjanayan harṣam
kuru-vṛddhaḥ pitāmahaḥ |
siṃha-nādam vinadyoccaiḥ
śaṅkhaṁ dadhmau pratāpavān ||

- ◆ **tasya** – his (Duryodhana’s); **sañjanayan** – causing; **harṣam** – joy;
- ◆ **kuru-vṛddhaḥ** – the aged of the Kuru clan; **pitāmahaḥ** – the grandfather (Bhishma);
- ◆ **siṃha-nādam** – a lion’s roar; **vinadya** – sounding; **uccaiḥ** – loudly;
- ◆ **śaṅkham** – conch shell; **dadhmau** – blew; **pratāpavān** – the glorious.

**Bhishma the grandsire, the glorious, the oldest of the Kurus,
gave forth a lion-roar and blew his conch, causing joy to
Duryodhana.**

VERSE 1.13

ततः शङ्खाश्च भेर्यश्च पणवानकगोमुखाः ।
सहसैवाभ्यहन्यन्त स शब्दस्तुमुलोऽभवत् ॥१३॥

tataḥ śaṅkhāś ca bheryaś ca
paṇavānaka-gomukhāḥ |
sahasāivābhyahanyanta
sa śabdastumulo'bhavat ||

- ◆ **tataḥ**—then; **śaṅkhāḥ**—conch shells; **ca**—and; **bheryaḥ**—kettledrums; **ca**—and;
- ◆ **paṇava-ānaka**—tabors and drums; **go-mukhāḥ**—horns;
- ◆ **sahasā**—suddenly; **eva**—certainly; **abhyahanyanta**—blared forth;
- ◆ **saḥ**—that; **śabdaḥ**—sound; **tumulaḥ**—tumultuous; **abhavat**—was.

(Following the example of Bhishma, other heroes blew the conches, and drums, trumpets, and horns were sounded.)
Then conchs and kettle-drums, tabors and trumpets and cow-horns suddenly blared forth; and the sound was stupendous.

VERSE 1.14

ततः श्वेतैर्हयैर्युक्ते महति स्यन्दने स्थितौ ।
माधवः पाण्डवश्चैव दिव्यौ शङ्खौ प्रदध्मतुः ॥ १४ ॥

tataḥ śvetair hayairyukte
mahati syandane sthitau |
mādhavaḥ pāṇḍavaś caiva
divyau śaṅkhau pradadhmatuḥ ||

- ◆ **tataḥ**—then; **śvetaiḥ**—with white; **hayaiḥ**—horses; **yukte**—yoked;
- ◆ **mahati**—in a magnificent; **syandane**—chariot; **sthitau**—seated;
- ◆ **mādhavaḥ**—Krishna; **pāṇḍavaḥ**—Arjuna; **ca**—and; **eva**—also;
- ◆ **divyau**—divine; **śaṅkhau**—conch shells; **pradadhmatuḥ**—blew.

**Whereupon Mādhava and Pāṇḍava, seated in their
magnificent chariot yoked to white horses, also blew their
celestial conchs.**

**Lord Hr̥ṣīkeśa blew His conch Pāñcajanya; Arjuna
(Dhananjaya) blew Devadatta; and Bhīma, the doer of
formidable deeds (Vṛkodara), blew his great conch Pauṇḍra.**

**King Yudhiṣṭhira, the son of Kuntī, blew his conch
Anantavijaya, while Nakula and Sahadeva blew Sughoṣa and
Maṇipuṣpaka, respectively.**

And the King of Kāśī, the great archer; and Śikhaṇḍī, the great chariot-warrior; Dhṛṣṭadyumna and Virāṭa; and Sātyaki, the unconquered (all blew their conches).

VERSE 1.18

द्रुपदो द्रौपदेयाश्च सर्वशः पृथिवीपते ।
सौभद्रश्च महाबाहुः शङ्खान् दध्मुः पृथक् पृथक् ॥१८॥

drupado draupadeyāś ca
sarvaśaḥ pṛthivīpate |
saubhadraś ca mahābāhuḥ
śaṅkhān dadhmuḥ pṛthak pṛthak ||

- ◆ **drupadaḥ**—Drupada; **draupadeyāḥ**—the sons of Draupadi; **ca**—and;
- ◆ **sarvaśaḥ**—all; **pṛthivī-pate**—O Lord of Earth;
- ◆ **saubhadraḥ**—the son of Subhadra (Abhimanyu); **ca**—and; **mahā-bāhuḥ**—mighty-armed;
- ◆ **śaṅkhān**—conches; **dadhmuḥ**—blew; **pṛthak pṛthak**—each their own.

O king (pṛthivīpate), Drupada and all the sons of Draupadī, as well as the mighty-armed Saubhadra (Abhimanyu), each blew their respective conches.

VERSE 1.19

स घोषो धार्तराष्ट्राणां हृदयानि व्यदारयत् ।
नभश्च पृथिवीं चैव तुमुलो व्यनुनादयन् ॥१९॥

sa ghoṣo dhārtarāṣṭrāṇām
hṛdayāni vyadārayat |
nabhaś ca prṥthivīm caiva
tumulo vyanunādayan ||

- ◆ **saḥ** – that; **ghoṣaḥ** – uproar; **dhārtarāṣṭrāṇām** – of the sons of Dhritarashtra;
- ◆ **hṛdayāni** – hearts; **vyadārayat** – rent/shattered;
- ◆ **nabhaḥ** – the sky; **ca** – and; **prṥthivīm** – the earth; **ca** – and; **eva** – also;
- ◆ **tumulaḥ** – tumultuous; **vyanunādayan** – vibrating/resounding.

And that tumult, resounding through heaven and earth, rent the hearts of Dhritarāshtra's followers.

VERSE 1.20

अथ व्यवस्थितान्दृष्ट्वा धार्तराष्ट्रान् कपिध्वजः ।
प्रवृत्ते शस्त्रसम्पाते धनुरुद्यम्य पाण्डवः ॥ २० ॥

atha vyavasthitān dr̥ṣṭvā
dhārtarāṣṭrān kapi-dhvajaḥ |
pravṛtte śastra-sampāte
dhanur udyamya pāṇḍavaḥ ||

- ◆ **atha** – then; **vyavasthitān** – standing in battle formation; **dr̥ṣṭvā** – seeing;
- ◆ **dhārtarāṣṭrān** – the sons of Dhritarashtra; **kapi-dhvajaḥ** – he whose flag is marked with Hanuman (Arjuna);
- ◆ **pravṛtte** – about to begin; **śastra-sampāte** – the discharge of weapons;
- ◆ **dhanuḥ** – bow; **udyamya** – taking up; **pāṇḍavaḥ** – the son of Pandu (Arjuna).

O King! Now seeing the Kauravas arrayed in battle order and the discharge of weapons about to begin, Arjuna took up his bow and spoke these words to Lord Krishna.

**Then, to Hṛṣīkeśa (Kṛṣṇa), Arjuna spoke these words, O King:
'O Acyuta (Kṛṣṇa), please position my chariot between both
armies.'**

VERSE 1.22

यावदेतान्निरीक्षेऽहं योद्धुकामानवस्थितान् ।
कैर्मया सह योद्धव्यमस्मिन् रणसमुद्यमे ॥ २२ ॥

yāvad etān nirīkṣe'ham
yoddhu-kāmān avasthitān |
kair mayā saha yoddhavyam
asmin raṇa-samudyame ||

- ◆ **yāvat** – so that; **etān** – these; **nirīkṣe** – may behold; **aham** – I;
- ◆ **yoddhu-kāmān** – desiring to fight; **avasthitān** – standing;
- ◆ **kaiḥ** – with whom; **mayā** – by me; **saha** – together; **yoddhavyam** – must be fought;
- ◆ **asmin** – in this; **raṇa-samudyame** – enterprise of war.

So that I may observe these individuals, standing here and eager to fight, and discern with whom I must engage in battle in this endeavor (raṇa-samudyama).

VERSE 1.23

योत्स्यमानानवेक्षेऽहं य एतेऽत्र समागताः ।
धार्तराष्ट्रस्य दुर्बुद्धेर्युद्धे प्रियचिकीर्षवः ॥ २३ ॥

yotsyamānān avekṣe'ham
ya ete'tra samāgatāḥ |
dhārtarāṣṭrasya durbuddher
yuddhe priya-cikīrṣavaḥ ||

- ◆ **yotsyamānān** – those who are going to fight; **avekṣe** – may behold; **aham** – I;
- ◆ **ye** – who; **ete** – these; **atra** – here; **samāgatāḥ** – gathered;
- ◆ **dhārtarāṣṭrasya** – of the son of Dhritarashtra (Duryodhana); **durbuddheḥ** – evil-minded;
- ◆ **yuddhe** – in the fight; **priya-cikīrṣavaḥ** – wishing to please.

I would observe these warriors assembled here for the battle wishing to please the evil-minded Duryodhana.

**O Bharata, thus addressed by Gudakesha (Arjuna),
Hrishikesha (Krishna), having placed the best chariot in the
middle of both armies...**

VERSE 1.25

भीष्मद्रोणप्रमुखतः सर्वेषां च महीक्षिताम् ।
उवाच पार्थ पश्यैतान्समवेतान्कुरुनिति ॥ २५ ॥

bhīṣma-droṇa-pramukhataḥ
sarveṣāṃ ca mahī-kṣitām |
uvāca pārtha paśyaitān
samavetān kurūn iti ||

- ◆ **bhīṣma-droṇa-pramukhataḥ** – in front of Bhishma and Drona;
- ◆ **sarveṣāṃ ca** – and all; **mahī-kṣitām** – the rulers of the earth;
- ◆ **uvāca** – said; **pārtha** – O Partha; **paśya** – behold; **etān** – these;
- ◆ **samavetān** – gathered; **kurūn** – Kurus; **iti** – thus.

...in front of Bhīṣma, Droṇa, and all the kings, he (Krishna)
said: 'O Pārtha (Arjuna), behold these assembled Kurus!'

VERSE 1.26

तत्रापश्यत्स्थितान् पार्थः पितृन्थ पितामहान् ।
आचार्यान्मातुलान्भ्रातृन्पुत्रान्पौत्रान्सखींस्तथा ।
श्वशुरान्सुहृदश्चैव सेनयोरुभयोरपि ॥ २६ ॥

tatrāpaśyat sthitān pārthaḥ
pitṛn atha pitāmahān |
ācāryān mātulān bhrātṛn
putrān pautrān sakhīṃs tathā |
śvaśurān suhṛdaś caiva
senayor ubhayor api ||

- ◆ **tatra** – there; **apaśyat** – saw; **sthitān** – standing; **pārthaḥ** – Arjuna;
- ◆ **pitṛn** – fathers/paternal uncles; **atha** – and; **pitāmahān** – grandfathers;
- ◆ **ācāryān** – teachers; **mātulān** – maternal uncles; **bhrātṛn** – brothers/cousins;
- putrān** – sons;
- ◆ **pautrān** – grandsons; **sakhīn** – friends; **tathā** – as well as;
- ◆ **śvaśurān** – fathers-in-law; **suhṛdaḥ** – well-wishers; **ca** – and; **eva** – also;
- senayoḥ ubhayoḥ api** – in both armies.

There Arjuna saw fathers, grand-fathers, teachers, uncles, brothers, sons, grandsons, companions, fathers-in-law, and friends in both the armies.

VERSE 1.27

तान्समीक्ष्य स कौन्तेयः सर्वान्बन्धूनवस्थितान् ।
कृपया परयाविष्टो विषीदन्निदमब्रवीत् ॥ २७ ॥

tān samīkṣya sa kaunteyaḥ
sarvān bandhūn avasthitān |
kṛpayā parayāviṣṭo
viṣīdann idam abravīt ||

- ◆ **tān** – them; **samīkṣya** – having seen; **saḥ** – he; **kaunteyaḥ** – the son of Kunti (Arjuna);
- ◆ **sarvān** – all; **bandhūn** – relatives; **avasthitān** – standing;
- ◆ **kṛpayā** – by pity/compassion; **parayā** – supreme/deep; **āviṣṭaḥ** – overwhelmed;
- ◆ **viṣīdan** – sorrowing; **idam** – this; **abravīt** – spoke.

Casting his eyes on all these kinsmen stationed on opposing sides, the son of Kunti was overcome with deep pity and sorrowfully spoke.

Overcome with supreme compassion (kṛpā), and lamenting, he said this: "O Kṛṣṇa, having seen these kinsmen, who are eager to fight and assembled (here)..."

My limbs are failing, and my mouth is parching. A trembling arises in my body, and my hair stands on end (horripilation occurs).

VERSE 1.30

गाण्डीवं संसते हस्तात्त्वक्चैव परिदह्यते ।
न च शक्नोम्यवस्थातुं भ्रमतीव च मे मनः ॥ ३० ॥

gāṇḍīvaṃ sraṃsate hastāt
tvak caiva paridahyate |
na ca śaknomy avasthātum
bhramatīva ca me manaḥ ||

- ◆ **gāṇḍīvaṃ** — the bow Gandiva; **sraṃsate** — is slipping; **hastāt** — from the hand;
- ◆ **tvak** — the skin; **ca** — and; **eva** — also; **paridahyate** — is burning;
- ◆ **na** — not; **ca** — and; **śaknomy** — I am able; **avasthātum** — to stand;
- ◆ **bhramati** — is reeling; **iva** — as if; **ca** — and; **me** — my; **manaḥ** — mind.

The Gāṇḍīva bow slips from my hand, and my skin is burning. I am also unable to stand firm, and my mind seems to be reeling.

VERSE 1.31

निमित्तानि च पश्यामि विपरीतानि केशव ।
न च श्रेयोऽनुपश्यामि हत्वा स्वजनमाहवे ॥ ३१ ॥

nimittāni ca paśyāmi
viparītāni keśava |
na ca śreyo'nupaśyāmi
hatvā svajanam āhave ||

- ◆ **nimittāni** — omens; **ca** — and; **paśyāmi** — I see;
- ◆ **viparītāni** — adverse; **keśava** — O Krishna;
- ◆ **na** — not; **ca** — and; **śreyaḥ** — good/benefit; **anupaśyāmi** — I foresee;
- ◆ **hatvā** — by killing; **svajanam** — own kinsmen; **āhave** — in battle.

**O Krishna! I see many ill-omens and I do not understand
what good could come by killing my own people in battle.**

VERSE 1.32

न काङ्क्षे विजयं कृष्ण न च राज्यं सुखानि च ।
किं नो राज्येन गोविन्द किं भोगैर्जीवितेन वा ॥ ३२ ॥

na kāṅkṣe vijayaṁ kṛṣṇa
na ca rājyaṁ sukhāni ca |
kiṁ no rājyena govinda
kiṁ bhogair jīvitena vā ||

◆ na—not; kāṅkṣe—I desire; vijayaṁ—victory; kṛṣṇa—O Krishna;

◆ na—not; ca—and; rājyaṁ—kingdom; sukhāni—pleasures; ca—and;

◆ kim—what; naḥ—to us; rājyena—by kingdom; govinda—O Govinda;

◆ kim—what; bhogaiḥ—by enjoyments; jīvitena—by life; vā—or.

**O Krishna! I do not desire victory or kingdom or pleasures.
Of what avail are these kingdom, enjoyment, or even life
itself to us.**

VERSE 1.33

Those for whom we desire a kingdom, enjoyments, and pleasures - they are present here in battle, having given up their lives and wealth.

VERSE 1.34

आचार्याः पितरः पुत्रास्तथैव च पितामहाः ।
मातुलाः श्वशुराः पौत्राः श्यालाः सम्बन्धिनस्तथा ॥ ३४ ॥

ācāryāḥ pitarāḥ putrās
tathaiva ca pitāmahāḥ |
mātulāḥ śvaśurāḥ pautrāḥ
śyālāḥ sambandhinas tathā ||

- ◆ ācāryāḥ—teachers; pitarāḥ—fathers/uncles; putrāḥ—sons;
- ◆ tathā eva—as also; ca—and; pitāmahāḥ—grandfathers;
- ◆ mātulāḥ—maternal uncles; śvaśurāḥ—fathers-in-law; pautrāḥ—grandsons;
- ◆ śyālāḥ—brothers-in-law; sambandhinas—relatives; tathā—as well.

Teachers, fathers, sons, and indeed grandfathers; maternal uncles, fathers-in-law, grandsons, brothers-in-law, and other relatives as well.

VERSE 1.35

एतान्न हन्तुमिच्छामि घ्नतोऽपि मधुसूदन ।
अपि त्रैलोक्यराज्यस्य हेतोः किं नु महीकृते ॥ ३५ ॥

etān na hantum icchāmi
ghnato'pi madhusūdana |
api trailokya-rājyasya
hetoh kim nu mahī-kṛte ||

- ◆ **etān** — these; **na** — not; **hantum** — to kill; **icchāmi** — I wish;
- ◆ **ghnataḥ** — being killed; **api** — even; **madhusūdana** — O Slayer of Madhu (Krishna);
- ◆ **api** — even; **trailokya** — of the three worlds; **rājyasya** — of the kingdom;
- ◆ **hetoh** — for the sake of; **kim nu** — what then; **mahī-kṛte** — for the sake of the earth.

These, O Madhusudana, I would not kill, though they should kill me, even for the sake of sovereignty over the three worlds - how much less for this earth!

VERSE 1.36

निहत्य धार्तराष्ट्रान्नः का प्रीतिः स्याज्जनार्दन ।
पापमेवाश्रयेदस्मान् हत्वैतानाततायिनः ॥ ३६ ॥

nihatya dhārtarāṣṭrān naḥ
kā prītiḥ syāj janārdana |
pāpam evāśrayed asmān
hatvaitān ātatāyinaḥ ||

- ◆ **nihatya** — by killing; **dhārtarāṣṭrān** — the sons of Dhritarashtra; **naḥ** — our;
- ◆ **kā** — what; **prītiḥ** — pleasure; **syāt** — will be; **janārdana** — O Krishna (Maintainer of all);
- ◆ **pāpam** — sin; **eva** — only; **āśrayet** — would take hold; **asmān** — us;
- ◆ **hatvā** — by killing; **etān** — these; **ātatāyinaḥ** — aggressors.

O Janārdana, what joy can be ours in killing these sons of Dhritarāshtra? Sin alone will possess us if we kill these felons.

VERSE 1.37

तस्मान्नार्हा वयं हन्तुं धार्तराष्ट्रान्स्वबान्धवान् ।
स्वजनं हि कथं हत्वा सुखिनः स्याम माधव ॥ ३७ ॥

tasmān nārhā vayaṃ hantum
dhārtarāṣṭrān svabāndhavān |
svajanaṃ hi katham hatvā
sukhinaḥ syāma mādharma ||

- ◆ **tasmāt**—therefore; **na arhāḥ**—not right/justified; **vayaṃ**—we; **hantum**—to kill;
- ◆ **dhārtarāṣṭrān**—the sons of Dhritarashtra; **sva-bāndhavān**—our own relatives;
- ◆ **svajanaṃ**—kinsmen; **hi**—certainly; **katham**—how; **hatvā**—by killing;
- ◆ **sukhinaḥ**—happy; **syāma**—may we be; **mādhava**—O Krishna.

Therefore we ought not to kill our kinsmen, the sons of Dhritarashtra; for, O Mādhava, how can we ever be happy by killing our own people?

Even though these (Kauravas), whose minds are corrupted by greed, do not perceive the fault arising from the destruction of the family, nor the sin in betraying friends...

VERSE 1.39

कथं न ज्ञेयमस्माभिः पापादस्मान्निवर्तितुम् ।
कुलक्षयकृतं दोषं प्रपश्यद्भिर्जनार्दन ॥ ३९ ॥

katham na jñeyam asmābhiḥ
pāpād asmān nivartitum |
kula-kṣaya-kṛtaṁ doṣaṁ
prapaśyadbhir janārdana ||

- ◆ **katham**—why; **na**—not; **jñeyam**—should be known; **asmābhiḥ**—by us;
- ◆ **pāpāt**—from sin; **asmāt**—this; **nivartitum**—to turn away;
- ◆ **kula-kṣaya**—destruction of family; **kṛtaṁ**—caused by; **doṣaṁ**—evil;
- ◆ **prapaśyadbhiḥ**—who see clearly; **janārdana**—O Krishna.

O Janārdana, how can we, who clearly foresee the fault (doṣa) arising from the destruction of a family, not know that we should turn away from this sin?

With the decay of a family, perish its dharmas, which have existed from time out of mind. With the ending of the dharmas, adharma overwhelms the whole family.

When adharma overwhelms the family, O Krishna, the women of the family become corrupt; and when, O Krishna, the women are corrupt, there arises a mixing of castes.

VERSE 1.42

सङ्करो नरकायैव कुलघ्नानां कुलस्य च ।
पतन्ति पितरो ह्येषां लुप्तपिण्डोदकक्रियाः ॥ ४२ ॥

saṅkaro narakāyaiva
kulaghnānām kulasya ca |
patanti pitaro hy eṣām
lupta-piṇḍodaka-kriyāḥ ||

- ◆ **saṅkaraḥ**—this intermingling; **narakāya**—to hell; **eva**—certainly;
- ◆ **kula-ghnānām**—for the destroyers of the family; **kulasya**—for the family; **ca**—and;
- ◆ **patanti**—fall; **pitarāḥ**—ancestors; **hi**—verily; **eṣām**—their;
- ◆ **lupta**—deprived of; **piṇḍa-udaka**—offerings of rice and water; **kriyāḥ**—rituals/performances.

This mixture leads into hell the family itself as well as those who destroy it; for their ancestors fall, deprived of the offerings of rice-balls and water.

By these evil deeds of the destroyers of families, which result in the mixing of castes, the eternal dharmas of caste and family are uprooted.

VERSE 1.44

उत्सन्नकुलधर्माणां मनुष्याणां जनार्दन ।
नरकेऽनियतं वासो भवतीत्यनुशुश्रुम ॥ ४४ ॥

utsanna-kula-dharmāṇām
manuṣyāṇām janārdana |
narake'niyataṁ vāso
bhavatīty anuśuśruma ||

- ◆ **utsanna**—destroyed; **kula-dharmāṇām**—for those whose family traditions are;
- ◆ **manuṣyāṇām**—of men; **janārdana**—O Krishna;
- ◆ **narake**—in hell; **aniyataṁ**—for an indefinite period; **vāsaḥ**—dwelling;
- ◆ **bhavati**—is; **iti**—thus; **anuśuśruma**—we have heard (from the scriptures).

We have heard it said, O Janārdana, that inevitably the men whose family dharmas are destroyed dwell in hell.

VERSE 1.45

अहो बत महत्पापं कर्तुं व्यवसिता वयम् ।
यद्राज्यसुखलोभेन हन्तुं स्वजनमुद्यताः ॥ ४५ ॥

aho bata mahat pāpaṃ
kartuṃ vyavasitā vayam |
yad rājya-sukha-lobhena
hantuṃ svajanam udyatāḥ || 45 ||

- ◆ **aho bata**—alas!; **mahat**—great; **pāpaṃ**—sin;
- ◆ **kartuṃ**—to do; **vyavasitāḥ**—prepared; **vayam**—we;
- ◆ **yad**—that; **rājya-sukha**—pleasures of the kingdom; **lobhena**—by greed for;
- ◆ **hantuṃ**—to kill; **svajanam**—our own kinsmen; **udyatāḥ**—set out.

Alas, we are resolved to commit a great sin, in that we are ready to slay our kinsmen to satisfy our greed for the pleasure of a kingdom!

VERSE 1.46

यदि मामप्रतीकारमशस्त्रं शस्त्रपाणयः ।
धार्तराष्ट्रा रणे हन्युस्तन्मे क्षेमतरं भवेत् ॥ ४६ ॥

yadi mām apratīkāram
aśastram śastra-pāṇayah |
dhārtarāṣṭrā raṇe hanyus
tan me kṣemataram bhavet || 46 ||

- ◆ **yadi**—if; **mām**—me; **apratīkāram**—unresisting;
- ◆ **aśastram**—unarmed; **śastra-pāṇayah**—with weapons in hand;
- ◆ **dhārtarāṣṭrā**—the sons of Dhritarashtra; **raṇe**—in battle; **hanyuh**—should kill;
- ◆ **tat**—that; **me**—for me; **kṣema-taram**—better/more beneficial; **bhavet**—would be.

**Far better would it be for me if the sons of Dhritarāshtra,
weapons in hand, should slay me in the battle, unarmed and
unresisting.**

VERSE 1.47

सञ्जय उवाच ।

एवमुक्त्वार्जुनः सङ्ख्ये रथोपस्थ उपाविशत् ।

विसृज्य सशरं चापं शोकसंविग्नमानसः ॥ ४७ ॥

sañjaya uvāca |

evam uktvārjunah saṅkhye

rathopastha upāviśat |

visṛjya sa-śaram cāpam

śoka-saṁvigna-mānasah || 47 ||

◆ **sañjayah uvāca** — Sanjaya said;

◆ **evam** — thus; **uktvā** — having spoken; **arjunah** — Arjuna; **saṅkhye** — on the battlefield;

◆ **ratha-upasthe** — on the seat of the chariot; **upāviśat** — sat down;

◆ **visṛjya** — casting aside; **sa-śaram** — along with arrows; **cāpam** — the bow;

◆ **śoka** — by grief; **saṁvigna** — overwhelmed; **mānasah** — mind.

Sanjaya said: Arjuna, having spoken thus on the battlefield, cast aside his bow and arrow and sank down on his chariot-seat, his mind overcome with grief.